

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6 4 2

♥ -

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ Q J 10 2

♠ -

♥ A K 9 6 5 4 2

♦ A Q 4

♣ K 7 5



♠ Q J 10 9

♥ Q J 8

♦ 6 5 2

♣ 8 4 3

♠ A 7 5 3

♥ 10 7 3

♦ K 9 8

♣ A 9 6

West

Pass

Pass

All Pass

North

1 ♥

4 ♥

East

Pass

South

2 ♥

4 ♥ by North

♠. Now play the ♠Q and when West plays low, discard a ♣. This is a loser on loser play and East takes the trick with the ♠A.

East now leads the ♥7. You cover with dummy's ♥8 knowing the finesse will win. Next you play dummy's ♠J, covered by West and ruffed by you (if West didn't cover you would throw another ♣ loser). Now enter dummy with the ♥Q, pulling East's last trump at the same time. Discard your 2 ♣s on the ♠ 10 9 and try the ♦ finesse for an overtrick.

This loser-on-loser play didn't have much to do with trump management.

Just the fact that you had to use the trump suit for entries to dummy, and therefore couldn't immediately pull trumps.

North is to play 4 ♥. East leads the ♥3.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 5

If West has the ♦K, one ♦ loser can be eliminated by a finesse. And, if West also has the ♣A one more loser can be eliminated by leading toward your ♣K. The chance of both cards being held by West isn't very good, only about 25%. But dummy has some nice ♠s. Can you use them?

Yes, you can establish 2 ♠ winners for discards, and most importantly, you can do it without letting West into the lead. This is important because if West gets in and plays a ♣ through your ♣ K 7 5 it might be a disaster.

So win the ♥J in dummy. Uh-Oh, West discards a

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 6
 ♥ 8 5 4 2
 ♦ K 8 7 2
 ♣ 9 5 4

♠ 10 5 2

♥ 10 9 3

♦ J 9 5 3

♣ K Q 8



♠ A Q J 9 7 4

♥ A 6

♦ A Q

♣ 6 3 2

♠ 8 3

♥ K Q J 7

♦ 10 6 4

♣ A J 10 7

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

1NT

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

... except when you have a good reason not to, like here.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=3 Total = 4

This is a very easy problem to be up here at number 18! Clearly you have to discard one of those 4 losers on the only card dummy has, the ♦ K.

Just as clearly you have to be able to enter dummy after you unblock the ♦ A Q so you can't pull trumps immediately.

So here's the Plan. Win the ♥ A. Pull one round of trumps with the ♠ A. Play the ♦ A Q to get them out of the way. Enter dummy with the ♠ K. Play the ♦ K, discard a loser, and hope nobody ruffs.

Just remember to always pull trumps immediately . . .